

IAA SETI Committee Report to Commission 1 Space Physical Sciences

IAA SETI Committee Report - September 2025

The IAA SETI Committee last convened in Milan during the International Astronautical Congress (IAC) 2024. The Chair's notes from this meeting can be accessed here:



[IAA SETI Committee IAC 2024 – Notes from the Chair](#)

Ongoing Activities

The committee is actively engaged in several key initiatives:

1. Revision of the IAA SETI Post-Detection Protocols (PDP)

- The committee is drafting a new version of the IAA SETI Committee Post-Detection Protocols (PDP), replacing the 2010 version.
- A preliminary draft was presented at IAC 2024.

2. Community Consultation on the PDP Draft

- A revised draft was distributed to the IAA members in May 2025 and the wider community in August 2025. Feedback was received via google forms, including respondent demographics.
- Based on this feedback process, a new September 2025 version of the document will be presented to the IAA SETI Committee membership at their annual meeting in Sydney.
- An associated paper will also be presented at the IAC 2025 (Session A4.2).
- The IAA SETI Committee members will be asked to approve the new PDP document after IAC 2025. The protocols will then be sent to the IAA BoT for their endorsement.

3. Preparation for the 54th IAA SETI Symposium at IAC 2025

- The programme for Science & Technology (A4.1) and SETI & Society (A4.2) is finalised - there is a strong programme of papers to be presented on technosignature searches, post-detection strategies, and emerging societal themes - the date/venue is Tuesday 7 October Room C4.2 in the main IAC 2025 Exhibition Centre

4. Next IAA SETI Committee Meeting at IAC 2025

- The committee aims to present and discuss an updated version of the draft PDPs during the next meeting in Sydney - Wednesday 8 October, 2025, Room E3.9 of the main Exhibition Centre.
- The main goal is to finalise the PDP document.

5. Preparation for the 55th IAA SETI Symposium at IAC 2026

- A proposal has been submitted for the recent deadline with the same format with 2 sessions: Science & Technology and SETI & Society. Chairs identified Dave deBoer (Oxford)/Karen Perez (SETI Institute) and Lori Walton (independent mineral consultant, Canada) and Paolo Musso (University of

Insubria, Varese, Italy).

6. In memoriam, Claudio Maccone (1948-2025)

The IAA SETI Committee membership and the wider SETI Community were saddened to learn of the passing of Claudio Maccone. A former IAA SETI Permanent Committee chair (2012-2021), Claudio made enormous contributions to the field of SETI, Planetary Defence, the IAA and Space Science more generally. At times when the field of SETI faced difficult challenges, Claudio was always there. He lived, breathed, and dreamed SETI. Beyond his scientific achievements and leadership, Claudio was a much-loved colleague, mentor, and friend. His generosity of spirit and his boundless enthusiasm for SETI were contagious. But for many, it is his personal warmth that we will remember and miss the most. He leaves behind not only an extraordinary body of work but also a profound void in our community and in the hearts of those who knew him well. At the upcoming IAA SETI Committee meeting in Sydney, we will take time to honour Claudio's life and legacy more fully.

Recent Engagements

The IAA SETI Committee also participated in and co-organised a SETI session as part of the symposium on the Peaceful Use of Space Technology – Health (IPSPACE 2024). This event took place from 10–13 December 2024, with a hybrid format (online and in-person) in Hainan, China. The session facilitated discussions on the intersection of space technology, peaceful applications, and SETI research. The session was very productive and demonstrated the interest of China in this field, especially through observations using the giant FAST radio telescope.

Recent SETI related meetings include Breakthrough Discuss (Oxford University, April 2025), and the Penn-State SETI meeting (August 2025). An IAU Symposium on Technosignatures is scheduled for March 2026.

The committee remains committed to fostering collaboration, dialogue, and policy development in the global Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence. For further details or to contribute to ongoing discussions, committee members and the wider community are encouraged to engage with our initiatives. For more information on our activities subscribe to the google group:

community@iaaseti.org

Mike Garrett, IAA SETI Committee chair.